

0.0.1 Talaputa

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Rajagaha in the Bamboo Grove, at the Squirrels' Feeding Place. Then Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: "This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: "The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement." Here, what does the Auspicious

tālapuṭasuttam

ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā rājagahe viharati veevane kalandaka nivāpe. atha kho tālapuṭo¹ naṭagāmaṇī yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho tālapuṭo naṭagāmaṇī bhagavantam etadavoca: sutam metam bhante pubbakānaṃ ācariyapācariyānaṃ naṭānaṃ bhāsamānānaṃ yo so naṭo raṅgamajjhe samajjamajjhe saccālikena jaṇaṃ bhāseti rameti, so kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā pahāsānaṃ devānaṃ saḥavyatam uppajja-

¹tālaputto - syā, aṭṭhakathā

One have to say about this?”
 “Enough Producer, leave this
 be. Do not ask me this.”

2. Also for a second time, Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: “This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement.” Here, what does the Auspicious One have to say about this?” “Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this.”

3. Also for a third time, Talaputa, the producer of

tīti. idha bhagavā
 kimāhāti. alaṃ gā-
 maṇī tiṭṭhatetaṃ,
 mā maṃ etaṃ puc-
 chi² ti.

dutiyampi kho tāla-
 puṭo naṭagāmaṇī
 bhagavantam eta-
 davoca: sutam me-
 tam bhante pubba-
 kānam ācariyapāca-
 riyaṇam naṭānam
 bhāsamānānam yo
 so naṭo raṅgamajjhe
 samajjamajjhe saccā-
 likena janam bhāseti
 rameti, so kāyassa
 bheda parammaraṇā
 pahāsānam devānam
 saḥavyataṃ upapaj-
 jatī ti. idha bhagavā
 kimāhāti. alaṃ gā-
 maṇī tiṭṭhatetaṃ mā
 maṃ etaṃ pucchiti.

tatiyampi kho tāla-

²pucchāti - sī 1. ■

comedy shows, said this to the Auspicious One: “This have been heard by me, O Bhante, from former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement.” Here, what does the Auspicious One have to say about this?”

4. Certainly, I, O Producer, could not gain your [consent] with this: “Enough Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this.” So then, I will answer you. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from lust, bounded to the bond of lust, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to

puṭo naṭagāmaṇī
bhagavantam eta-
davoca, sutam me-
tam bhante pubba-
kānam ācariyapāca-
riyānaṃ naṭānaṃ
bhāsamānānaṃ yo
so naṭo raṅgamajjhe
samajjamajjhe saccā-
likena janam bhāseti
rameti, so kāyassa
bhedā parammaraṇā
pahāsānaṃ devānaṃ
sahavyataṃ upapaj-
jatī ti. idha bhagavā
kimāhāti. idha bha-
gavā kimāhāti.

addhā kho tyāhaṃ
gāmaṇī na labhāmi³
alam gāmaṇī tiṭṭha-
tetam mā maṃ etaṃ
pucchī ti. api ca tyā-
haṃ vyākarissāmi.
pubbe kho gāmaṇī,
sattā avītarāgā rā-
gabandhanabaddhā

³nālattham - syā, pts ■

things that are provocative of lust for increasing their lust even more. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from hate, bounded to the bond of hate, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to things that are provocative of hate for increasing their hate even more. Beings, O Producer, who are formerly not free from delusion, bounded to the bond of delusion, for them a comedian at centre stage in the middle of a show draws their mind to things that are provocative of delusion for increasing their delusion even more. He himself being intoxicated and negligent, having caused others to be intoxicated and negligent, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises there in the hell called amusement.

⁴, tesam naṭo raṅga-
majjhe samajjamaj-
jhe ye dhammā ra-
janīyā te upasaṃha-
rati bhiyyo sarāgāya
⁵. pubbe kho gāmaṇī
sattā avītadosā dosā-
bandhanabaddhā, te-
sam naṭo raṅgamaj-
jhe samajjamajjhe ye
dhammā dosanīyā te
upasaṃharati bhiyyo
sadosāya⁶. pubbe
kho gāmaṇī, sattā
avītamohā moha-
bandhanabaddhā,
tesam naṭo raṅga-
majjhe samajjamaj-
jhe ye dhammā mo-
hanīyā te upasaṃ-
harati bhīyyo samo-
hāya⁷. so attanā matto
pamatto pare ma-
detvā pamādetvā
kāyassa bhedā pa-
rammaraṇā pahāso

⁴bandhā - syā. ■

⁵bhiyyosomattāya - machasaṃ ■

⁶bhiyyosomattāya - machasaṃ ■

⁷bhiyyosomattāya - machasaṃ ■

5. But if he is of such a view: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement,” that is wrong view. For an individual of wrong view, O Producer, his destiny is a certain one of these two destinies, I say. “Either the hell realm or the animal womb.”

6. When thus was said, Tala-puta, the producer of comedy shows, cried out, bursted out in tears.

7. I could not gain your [consent] with this: “Enough

nāma nirayo tatthup-
pajjati⁸.

sace kho panassa
evaṃ diṭṭhī hoti 'yo
so naṭo raṅgamajjhe
samajjamajjhe saccā-
likena janamaṃ bhāseti
rameti, so kāyassa
bhedā parammaraṇā
pahāsānaṃ devānaṃ
sahavyataṃ uppaj-
jati' ti sāssa hoti mic-
chā diṭṭhi, micchā
diṭṭhikassa kho pa-
nāmaṃ gāmaṇī puri-
sapuggalassa dvin-
naṃ gatīnaṃ añña-
taraṃ gatiṃ vadāmi
nirayaṃ vā tirac-
chānayaṇiṃ vāti.

evaṃ vutte tālapuṭo
naṭagāmaṇī parodi,
assūni pavattesi.

⁸tattha uppajjati - machasaṃ,
syā. ■

Producer, leave this be. Do not ask me this.”

8. I, O Bhante, am not crying because of this which the Auspicious One has said to me thus. Rather, I, O Bhante, I have been defrauded, deceived, and misled by former comedians, Teachers of teachers, saying: “The comedian who on centre stage in the middle of a show speaks with distortion of the truth to cause people to amuse themselves, with the breakup of the body, after death, arises in companionship with the devas of great amusement.”

9. “Excellent, O Bhante! Excellent, O Bhante! Just as, O Bhante, one might set upright what has been overturned, or open up what has been closed, or show a path to one

etaṃ kho tyāhaṃ
gāmaṇī nālatthaṃ,
alaṃ gāmaṇī tiṭṭha-
tetaṃ mā maṃ etaṃ
pucchi'ti.

nāhaṃ bhante etaṃ
rodāmi, yaṃ maṃ
bhagavā evamāha,
api cāhaṃ bhante
pubbakehi ācariya-
pācariyehi naṭehi
dīgharattaṃ nikato
vañcito paraddho⁹.
yo so naṭo raṅgamaj-
jhe samajjamajjhe
saccālikena jaṇaṃ
bhāseti rameti, so
kāyassa bhedā pa-
rammaraṇā pahāsā-
naṃ devānaṃ saha-
vyataṃ uppajjatī ti.

abhikkantaṃ bhante,
abhikkantaṃ bhante,
seyyathāpi bhante
nikkujjitaṃ vā ukkuj-
jeyya, paṭicchannaṃ

⁹paluddho - machasaṃ

who is lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so, O Bhante, has the Dhamma been explained by the Auspicious One in countless ways. I go, O Bhante, to the Auspicious One, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Bhikkhu Sangha. May I gain the going forth in the Auspicious One's presence, may I obtain the higher ordination."

10. "Talaputa, the producer of comedy shows, gained the going-forth in the Auspicious One's presence, gained the higher ordination. Not long after his higher ordination, the venerable Talaputa, dwelling alone, withdrawn, vigilant, ardent, resolute, not long entered upon

vā vivareyya, mūlahassa vā maggaṃ ācikkheyya, andhakāre vā telapajjotaṃ dhāreyya cakkhumanto rūpāni dakkhintīti. evamevaṃ bhagavatā anekapariyāyena dhammo pakāsito. esāhaṃ bhante bhagavantaṃ saraṇaṃ gacchāmi dhammañca bhikkhusaṅghañca, labheyyāhaṃ bhante bhagavato santike pabbajjaṃ labheyyaṃ upasampadanti.

alattha kho tālapuṭo naṭagāmiṇi bhagavato santike pabbajjaṃ, alatthupasampadaṃ, acirūpasampanno ca paṇāasmā tālapuṭo eko vūpakaṭṭho appamatto ātāpi pahitatto viharanto na cirasseva yassat-

and dwelled in that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life. He understood: “Destroyed is birth, lived is the life of purity, done is what had to be done, there is no other for thusness.” And the venerable Talaputa became one of the arahants.”

thāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttariyaṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sa-yaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihāsi, khīṇā jāti, vusitaṃ brahmacariyaṃ, kataṃ karaṇiyaṃ, nāparaṃ itthātāyāti abbhaññāsi, aññataro ca panāyasmā tālapuṭo arahataṃ ahoṣīti.

